

Semi-Secret Wars

Documentation Structure

Version: 0.2

Status: Living Document

This folder contains all project documentation. Documentation evolves alongside the game and always reflects the current state of the project. Unknown information is never invented — use **TBD** until a decision has been made.

README.md

Project overview: game summary, current status, engine version, repository structure, documentation links. Audience: everyone.

Game_Design_Bible.md

Defines what the game is: current scope/direction, core loop, heroes, villains, battlefields, priorities, combat, progression, rewards, art direction, known TBDs. Does not contain technical implementation. Owner: Lead Game Designer (Richard).

CLAUDE.md / AI_Development_Guide.md

Defines how the AI developer (Claude) works this project: roles, session workflow, milestone rules, coding standards, documentation and testing rules, end-of-session report format. Audience: the AI developer, technical lead, programmers.

BACKLOG.md

Tracks all planned work. Each item: feature, priority, status, dependencies, notes. Changes frequently.

CHANGELOG.md

Records completed milestones: date, systems added, systems modified, known issues.

BALANCE.md

Stores gameplay values: hero/enemy stats, XP/gold economy, ability-mod magnitudes, damage formulas, balance-sweep results. Every gameplay value should eventually live here instead of in source code.

LOCALIZATION.md

Tracks player-facing text: localization keys, languages, UI/hero/ability names. Mostly TBD — no localization pass yet.

DECISIONS.md

Records important project decisions: date, decision, reason, alternatives, impact. Explains WHY decisions were made — currently holds the 7 ratified decisions behind the run-chain rework plus the design-testing playtest fixes.

ART_BIBLE.md / AUDIO_BIBLE.md

Define the visual and audio language respectively. Both start small and expand as production grows; audio is still mostly TBD.

PRODUCTION.md

Tracks project production: current milestone, previous milestones, completed-milestone list, demo scope, next candidates, production notes. The single place to check "where is the project right now."

Repository Philosophy

Every document has a single responsibility. The project should never have one enormous document. Small documents → easy maintenance → easy AI context → lower token usage → better onboarding → professional organization.

Documentation Rules

- Keep documents concise.
- Update only documents affected by a milestone, and only in a batch at session end.
- Never duplicate information across documents — update the original source.
- Use TBD when a decision has not yet been made.
- The Game Design Bible is the source of truth for gameplay.
- PRODUCTION.md / CLAUDE.md are the source of truth for current state and development practices.